urbanization(n) : process of the formation and growth of cities

vital(adj) : very important

insecticide(n) : a substance used to kill insects

prosperity(n) : having good fortune

enthusiast(n) : a person who is very interested in and involved

DO YOU KNOW?

The Ministry of Environment and Forest recently announced that there are 14 species of birds that might not fly anymore in the future and might be extinct in India. The announcement came after International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) informed the ministry.The three main reasons for the threatened status of these birds, according to IUCN is poaching, excessive use of insecticides and loss of habitat. White-rumped Vulture,Indian Vulture, Red-headed Vulture, Siberian Crane, Bengal Florican, Himalayan Quail, Forest Owlet, White-belled Heron,Sociable Lapwing, Christmas Frigatebird,Jerdon's Courser, Pink-headed Duck,Spoon billed Sandpiper,Great Indian Bustard. If you would like to see these birds, go to the link :http://indiasendangered.com/14-species-of-birds-on-the-verge-of-extinction/

There are 15 wildlife and 15 bird sanctuaries that together cover over 2997.60 km^2, 2.30% of the total state area of Tamilnadu.

Language Study.

Look at the words 'agriculture' and 'horticulture'

The suffix "- culture" is added to mean growth or cultivation

Based on this model, a few terms for the cultivation or growing of specific plants or animals are mentioned below.

A) Words	B) **Meaning**
a) agriculture	- farming
b) apiculture	- bee-keeping
c) aquaculture	- aquatic animals or plants
d) aviculture	- birds
e) floriculture	- flowers
f) horticulture	- gardening

Now match the Column A with Column B.

A) Words	B) **Meaning**
a) mariculture	- development of sustainable agriculture
b) monoculture	- raising of fish in tanks
c) permaculture	- silk and silkworms
d) sericulture	- earthworms
e) pisciculture	- sea fish or other marine life
f) vermiculture	- grapevines
g) viticulture	- cultivation of only one sort of crop

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